

*“Well, why don't you take a break for a few minutes and sharpen the saw?” you inquire. “I’m sure it would go a lot faster.”*

*“I don't have time to sharpen the saw,” the man says emphatically. “I'm too busy sawing!”*

Doesn't it sound familiar? We seemingly never have time in life to do all those "little things" which have tremendous consequences in our lives.

It's all about preserving and enhancing the greatest asset you have — you. It is about renewing the four dimensions of your nature — physical, spiritual, mental, and social/emotional. Unless we renew, rejuvenate, refresh and re-launch these dimensions with fresh enthusiasm, we may get bogged down by the operational boredom of the act we are in.

While Stephen Covey talks about this from all dimensions of nature, my reference in this book is specific to sharpening your 'financial' saw. Learning, implementing your financial knowledge to achieve results, learning again from the results of your implementation and applying that learning back to yield better results next time is what we call a "continuous improvement" cycle in software engineering. Applying this cycle to your financial planning is a significant step by itself.

An even greater step is to continuously learn and challenge the existing paradigms, take risks and do something that keeps pace with the times. While financial principles remain the same, we need to keep ourselves updated on the latest developments. These latest developments provide the context or the area where your financial thinking must work to take financially wise decisions.

Most of our mental development and study discipline comes through formal education. But as soon as we leave the external discipline of school, many of us let our minds just wander around. We do not do any more serious reading, we do not explore new subjects in any real depth outside our field of work, we do not think analytically, we do not write — at least not critically or in away that tests our ability to express ourselves in clear and concise language. Instead, we spend our time watching television. I am grateful to television and other sources of information for the many high-